



How much childcare really costs

Rhianna Ruggiero

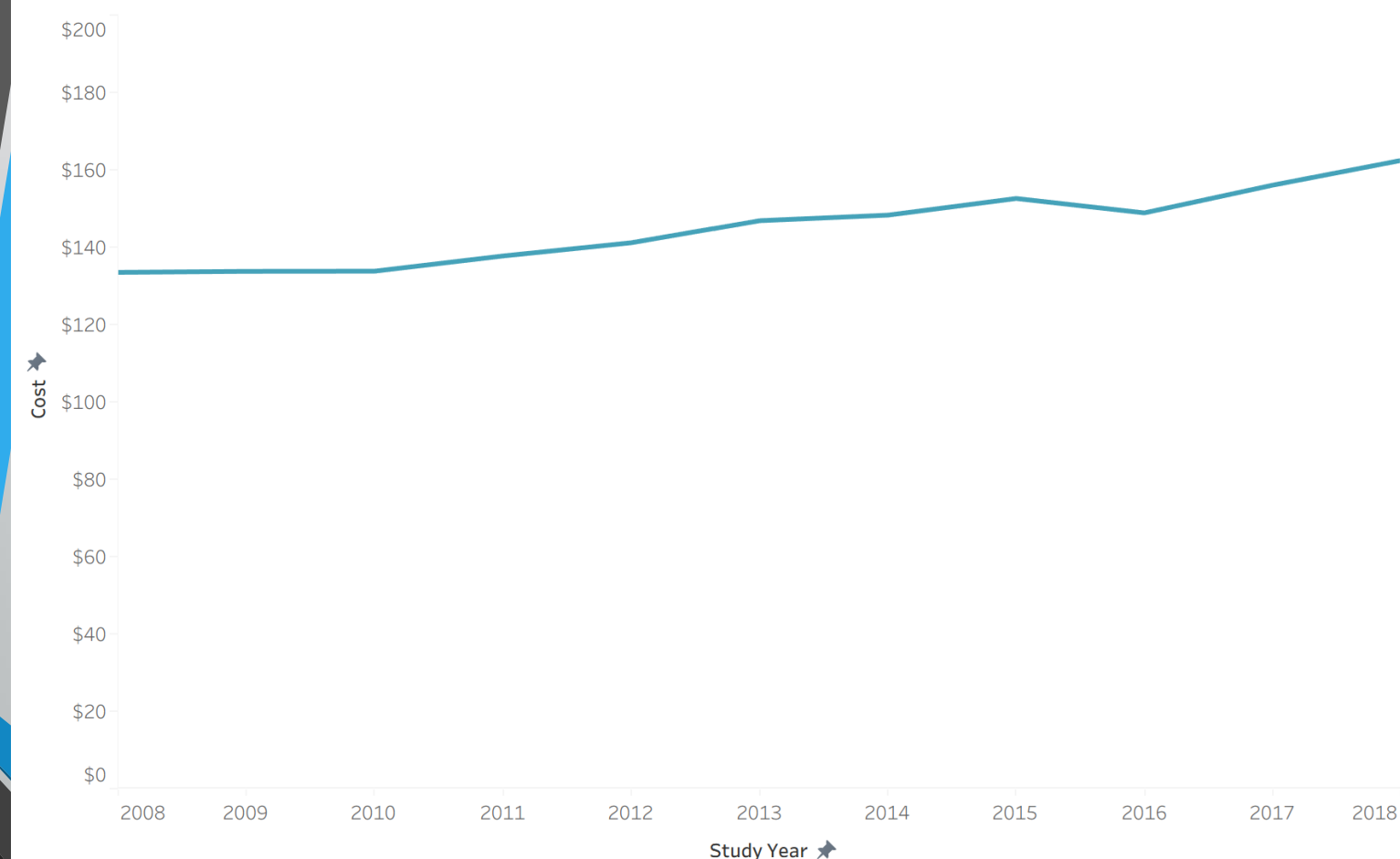
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Childcare is **expensive**

- Not many people know the true cost of childcare and that it can cost tens of thousands of dollars per year
- Some parents even stay home with their children while their spouse goes to work since the cost of childcare would be the same amount of money that one parent makes per year...
- New York has some of the highest costs for childcare in the country
- Once we return to work, we will have to put our infant in childcare during the workday which will cost us a lot of money

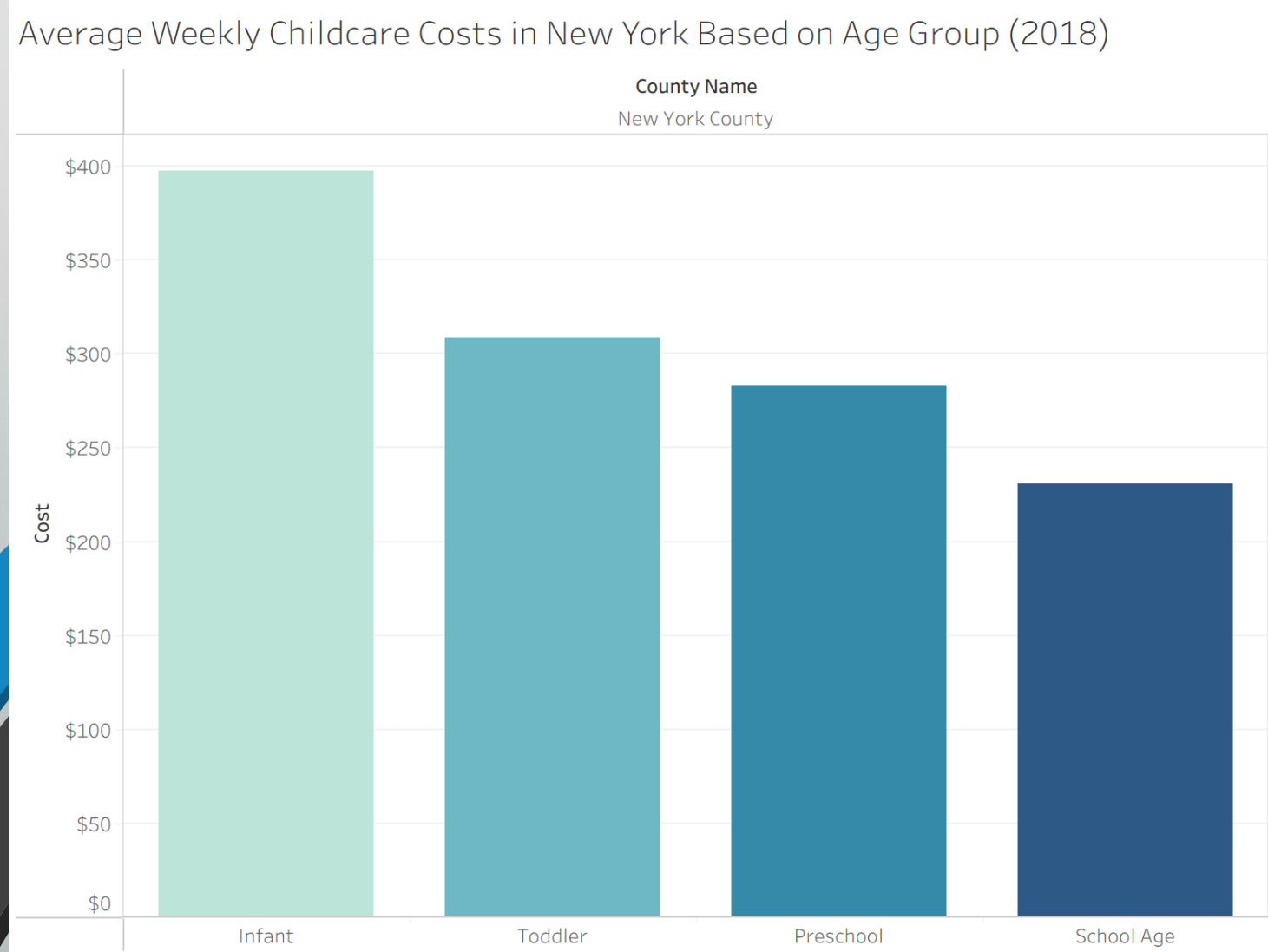
How have childcare prices changed over time?

Average Weekly Infant Childcare Cost in the US Over Time



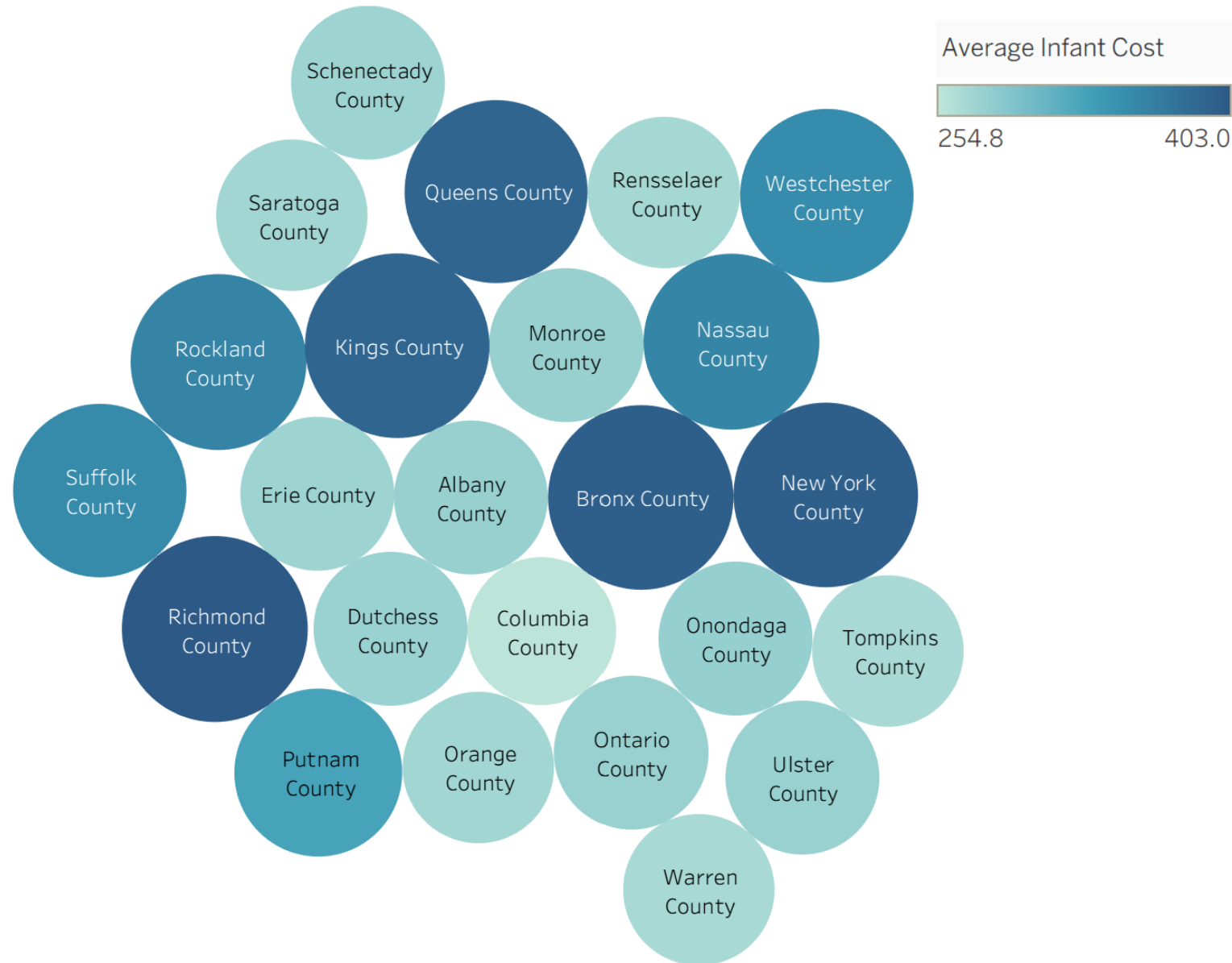
- The average weekly cost of childcare has slowly increased from 2008 to 2018 for all ages, including infants
- The average cost in 2008 in the US for weekly infant childcare was around **\$133** and increased to **\$162** in 2018
- Prices are steadily increasing over time...

How cost changes with a child's age



- Infants have the highest average weekly cost for childcare
- In New York County the average weekly childcare cost for infants is almost **\$400**
- Even though costs decrease as a child ages, the cost remains over \$300 a week for the first 3 years of a child's life

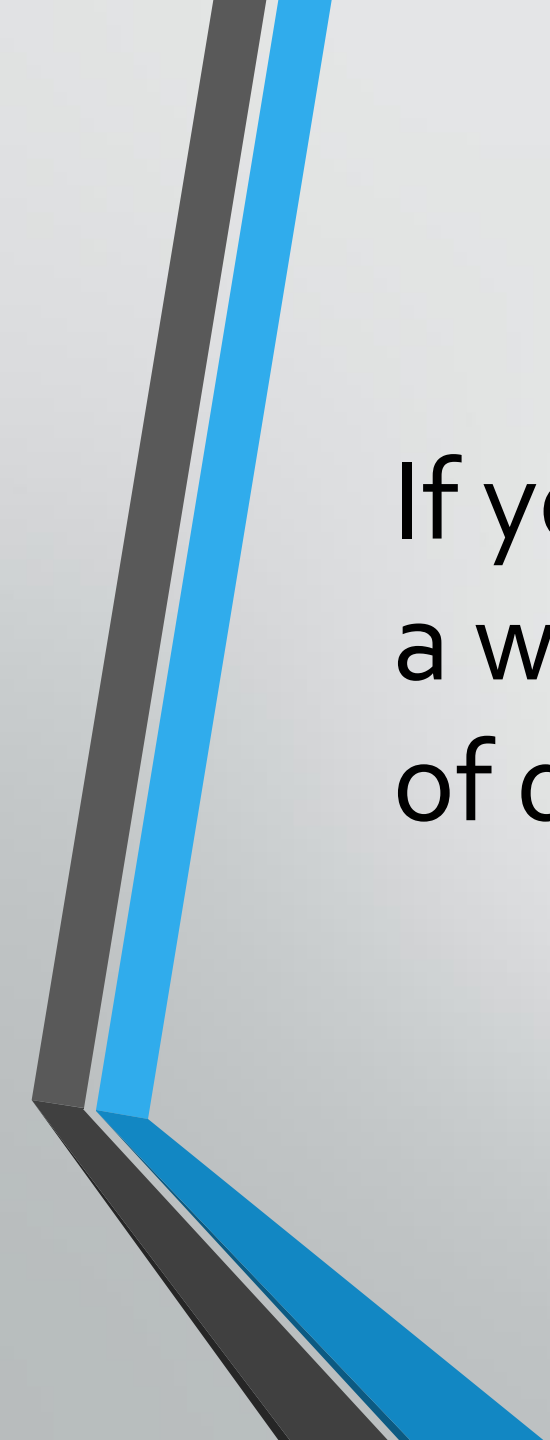
Most Expensive Counties in NY for Weekly Infant Childcare



- New York has some of the highest childcare costs in the US
- The counties with the highest weekly average cost for childcare include Richmond County, Bronx County and New York County that have prices close to \$400 per week
- Other counties, specifically in Upstate New York, have significantly lower costs below \$300 dollars a week which is around \$100 in comparison
- This can lead to a difference of around **\$5000** a year spent on childcare based on county alone

Childcare costs are extremely high

- The cost of childcare in New York County can be upwards of \$400 a week for infants
- This adds up to over \$20,000 a year that can be better spent towards children's education or saved for their college degree
- Costs do decrease as a child gets older; however, costs still increase every year for each individual age group
- Even just a few days a week without having to pay for childcare could help save a lot of money...



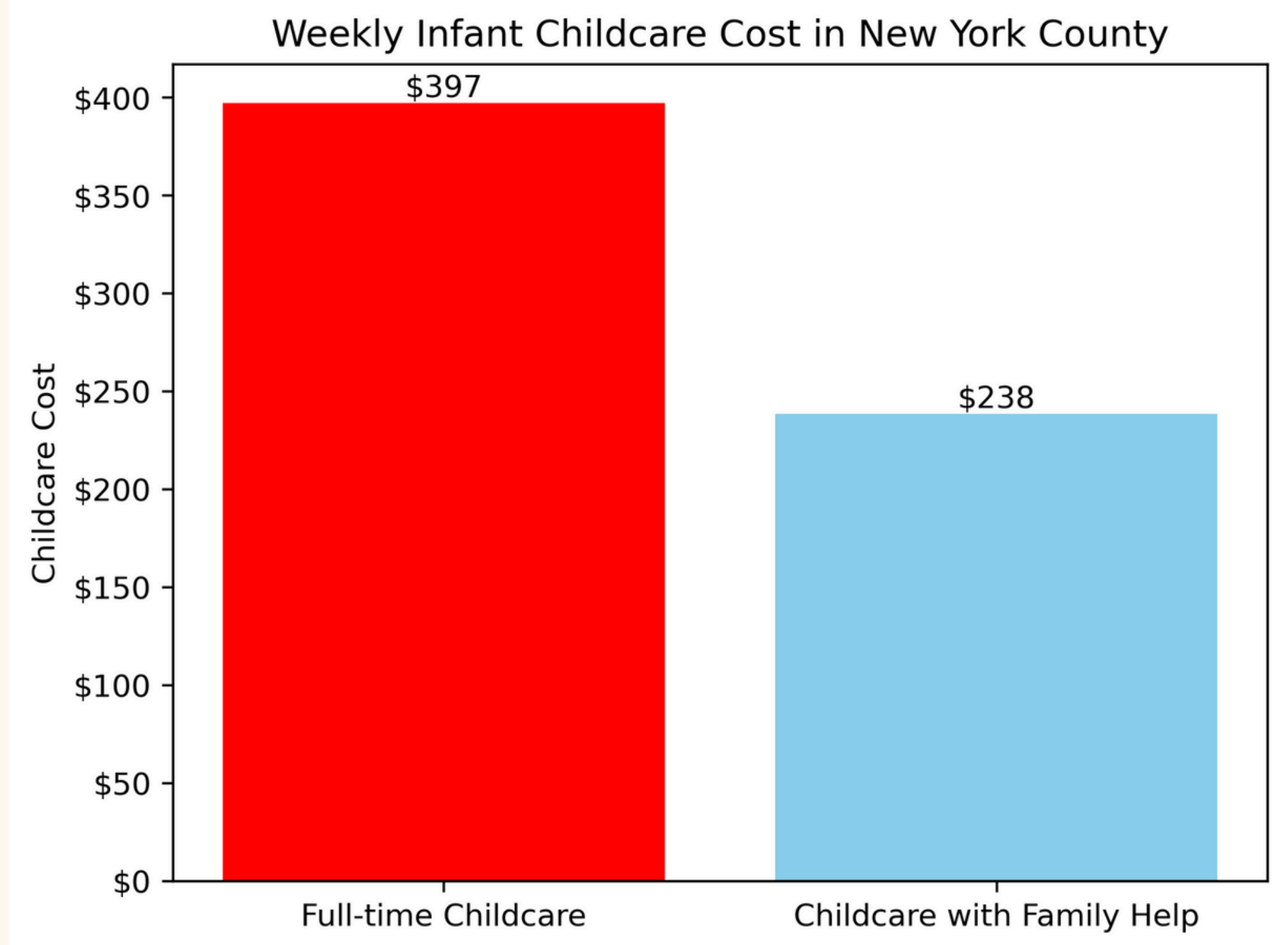
If you helped us watch our child just 2 days
a week, we could save tens of thousands
of dollars for our child's future!

... so, would you be willing to
help us watch our child 1 to 2
days per week to help us save
money?

CHILDCARE COSTS MORE THAN YOU REALIZE

WE COULD
SAVE UP TO
\$159
PER WEEK
WITH YOUR
HELP!*

*If you help us watch
our child 2 days a week



Yearly cost for full time infant childcare:
\$21,000

With your help we can save
\$88,000 to help pay for our
child's college degree!



Family support makes a meaningful difference

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Milestone 5

Summary of Analysis:

While looking through the data on Tableau I made a few different exploratory visualizations. I discovered that prices have increased over time for both family and center-based childcare. I also discovered that the price for childcare can vary greatly between counties in the same state. Prices for childcare decrease as children get older, which is likely due to them needing less supervision. I needed to clarify that prices do increase for each individual age group over time, and I am also assuming that this data is accurate even though there is some imputed data. I also assumed that the average weekly data represents the cost of about 5 days a week of childcare and made calculations for daily childcare cost based on that.

Direction of Story/Plan of Attack/Message you want to get across:

I want to convince my parents and siblings to help me watch my child a few days a week since childcare prices are so high. I want them to understand how much childcare costs and hope that they will consider watching the child two days a week. I explained how much childcare costs around the country, how much they are in my county and how costs can change with a child's age. I also show how much money can be saved by watching my child two days a week and even show how much can be saved up for college with extra help. In my video I also show how much of a person's monthly average income in New York County goes to childcare costs and show how that may change if there are two less days of childcare a week.

Target Audience:

The target audience for this presentation will be my parents and siblings that could help with childcare. They already will know who I am, so I will already have credibility with them. They also will most likely have bias since they know me and my child will be their grandchild/niece which will probably make them more likely to listen and agree with me. They may not be familiar with the data specifically but may have personal experiences with childcare prices.

Mediums you Included & Why:

For this project, I included a PowerPoint presentation since I will have everyone together in one room and be able to show the presentation to them all at once. The presentation shows facts about how expensive childcare is in New York County. I also made an infographic to be handed out to everyone that will focus on the main points that I want to get across. This includes information on how much money can be saved if my family helps watch my child 2 days a week.

The infographic is meant to be simple and something that everyone can easily reference. I also made a video that focuses on how much of a household's income goes to childcare costs in New York County. The video also has simple facts that show how much costs have increased over the years and how much money can be saved per year if my family watched my child for 2 days out of the week. I made sure that the visuals were simple enough to be understood in the video.

Design Decisions:

For each medium, I used the same color scheme for each of the visuals. In the presentation, I made sure to use a teal/blue color scheme. In both the infographic and video I used a red, blue and gray color scheme. The infographic shows important information in bold or striking colors. I also made sure that in the bar chart that the red bar shows the large price for full-time childcare and that the blue bar shows the price for childcare 3 times a week. In the video I show two pie charts with the same components and made sure that the components were the same color. I also made sure that the red pie slice was aligned in a similar way between the two visuals so that they could be easily compared.

Ethical Considerations:

The data came from the National Database of Childcare Prices from the U.S. Department of Labor - Women's Bureau. The data was also ethically collected from state studies of childcare prices from 2008 to 2018. Some changes that I made to the data include filtering to New York County and the year 2018 for a lot of visualizations. I also converted the weekly average costs to a daily cost in some cases in order to determine how much less it would cost to have my child in childcare 3 days a week rather than 5. There are also some legal guidelines for this data in that childcare providers must keep records confidential and not release personally identifying information. I made some assumptions with the data including that I assumed that average weekly childcare costs would be equal to 5 days of full-time childcare per week. Some risks could include that some visualizations are specific to New York county and others are for the United States. The numbers will be different specifically to New York, so it is important that the audience knows which chart is showing NY specific data and to clearly indicate what the visual is showing. The only data that I had for New York is also specific to 2018 which should have been clearly indicated.

Lessons Learned:

Next time I would choose a different angle for my story so that I could use more of the data included in the dataset like unemployment rate and could compare how prices might change in different locations and what the relevant unemployment rate is. I enjoyed being able to choose my own mediums for this project and to use any tool that I chose. This allowed me to test my skills in both Tableau and Python and to use the best tool for the specific visual that I needed.